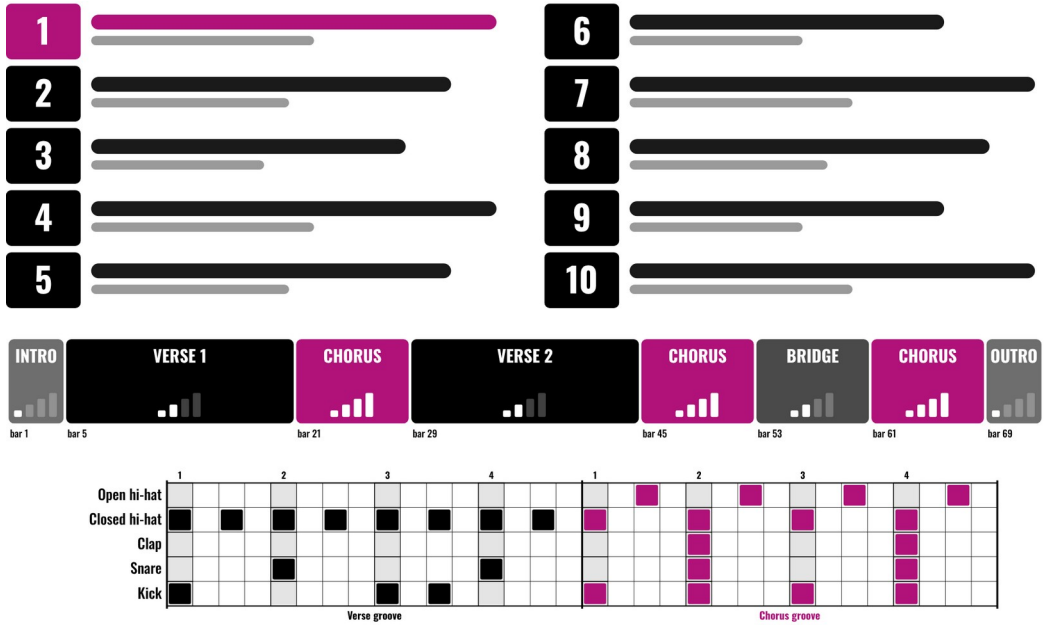
HUDSON BEAT



BILLBOARD TOP 10

Feat. this week's Hot 100

DIGITAL MUSIC PRODUCTION 2 · CLASS 1 · SONG FORM AND DRUMS IN LOGIC PRO

LISTEN: THIS WEEK'S NO. 1

THIS WEEK'S BILLBOARD HOT 100

the No. 1 song

Teacher: open the chart; play the No. 1 from YouTube or Spotify.

- How long until the first chorus?
- What instruments can you hear?
- Clap the beat: fast, medium or slow?

WHAT THE HECK IS EMULATION?

- Recreating a track’s style and sound as closely as you can
- Not just copying: reverse-engineering a hit
- Same tempo, same form, your own drums
- Then build your own version from scratch

SEVEN CLASSES

CLASS 1	Explore the Top 10 · Top 10 analysis · begin song form
CLASS 2	Finish the Song Form map · tempo and markers · drums
CLASS 3	Working day: build your foundation
CLASS 4	Working day: add layers
CLASS 5	Working day: refine the arrangement
CLASS 6	Mix and bounce · checklist · rubric · 3 questions
CLASS 7	Presentations with Padlet Q&A

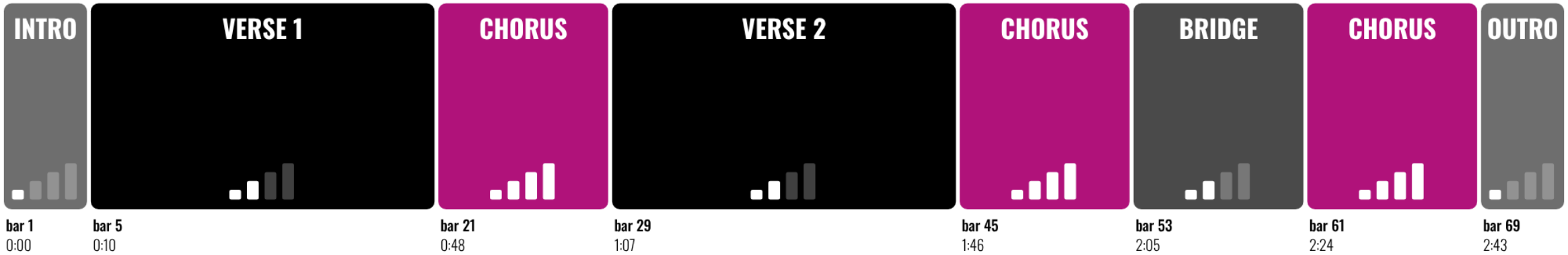
STEP 1: EXPLORE THE TOP 10

1. Listen to all 10 songs
2. Fill in the Top 10 analysis
3. Pick one song with clear, easy-to-hear sections
4. Start counting bars: where does each section begin?

SONG FORM: WHAT TO LISTEN FOR

- Intro, verse, chorus, bridge, outro
- Count the bars in every section
- Write down when each section starts
- Finish the Song Form map before Logic

WORKED EXAMPLE: A MAPPED SONG

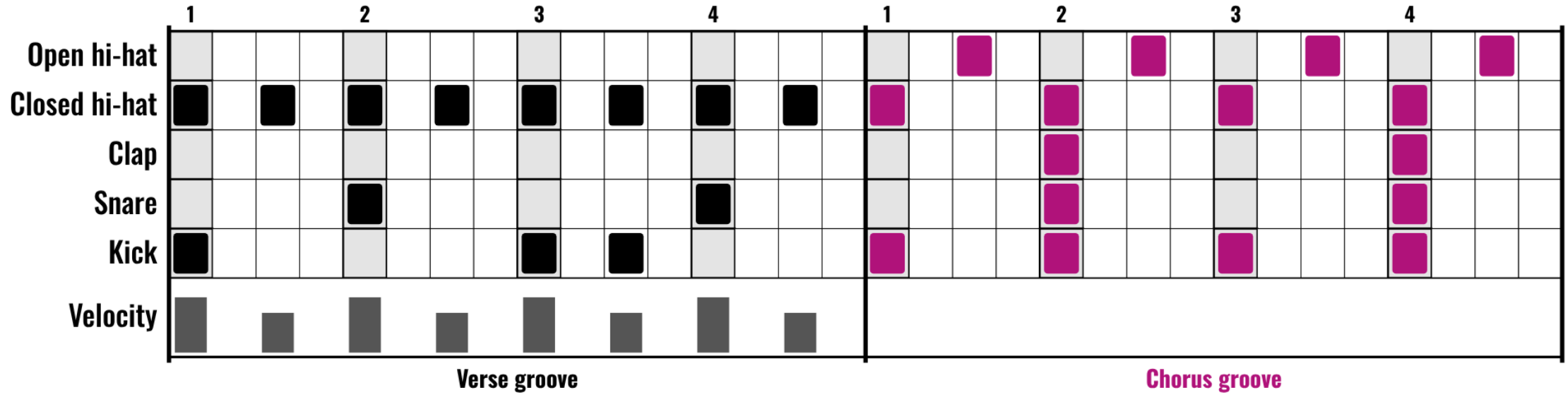


- 72 bars at 100 BPM: 2:53
- One Arrangement Marker per section
- Count bars, not seconds
- Verses 16 bars, choruses 8

WATCH ME: TEMPO AND MARKERS

1. Count the beats for 15 seconds, then × 4 = BPM
2. Set the project tempo to match
3. Metronome on (K): play the song alongside it
4. Global Tracks (G): one Arrangement Marker per section
5. Save as: Your Name – Billboard Top 10

WORKED EXAMPLE: BREAK DOWN THE DRUMS



- Verse: hi-hat eighths, snare on 2 and 4
- A clap doubles the snare in the chorus
- Chorus: kick on every beat, open hi-hats
- Velocity: louder on the beat, softer between

WATCH ME: PROGRAM THE DRUMS

1. New track: an Electronic Drum Kit (Drum Machine Designer)
2. Pattern region at the first verse marker
3. Kick, snare, hi-hat first: copy what you hear
4. Vary the velocity so it doesn’t sound robotic
5. Copy it into every section that uses it

BUILD YOUR FOUNDATION

- Bass, chords and core instruments
- Match the original’s energy, section by section
- Pick sounds that fit the genre
- Your drums are the backbone

ADD LAYERS

- Melodies, pads, FX and transitions
- Match the fullness of the original
- Capture the vibe, structure and energy
- You don’t need every single sound

MIX AND REFINE

- EQ every track
- Pan for width
- Adjust levels
- Add plug-ins for authenticity

WHAT YOU TURN IN

- [ ] Top 10 analysis completed
- [ ] Song form as Arrangement Markers in Logic
- [ ] Bounced .mp3 or .wav uploaded
- [ ] Zipped .logicx project uploaded
- [ ] Named: Your Name – Billboard Top 10
- [ ] Padlet post with your 3 questions
- [ ] Answer 2 questions on classmates' posts

HOW IT'S SCORED

CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	5 = Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive	/ 5
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	5 = Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems	/ 5
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	5 = Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc	/ 5
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	5 = Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix	/ 5
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	5 = Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery	/ 5

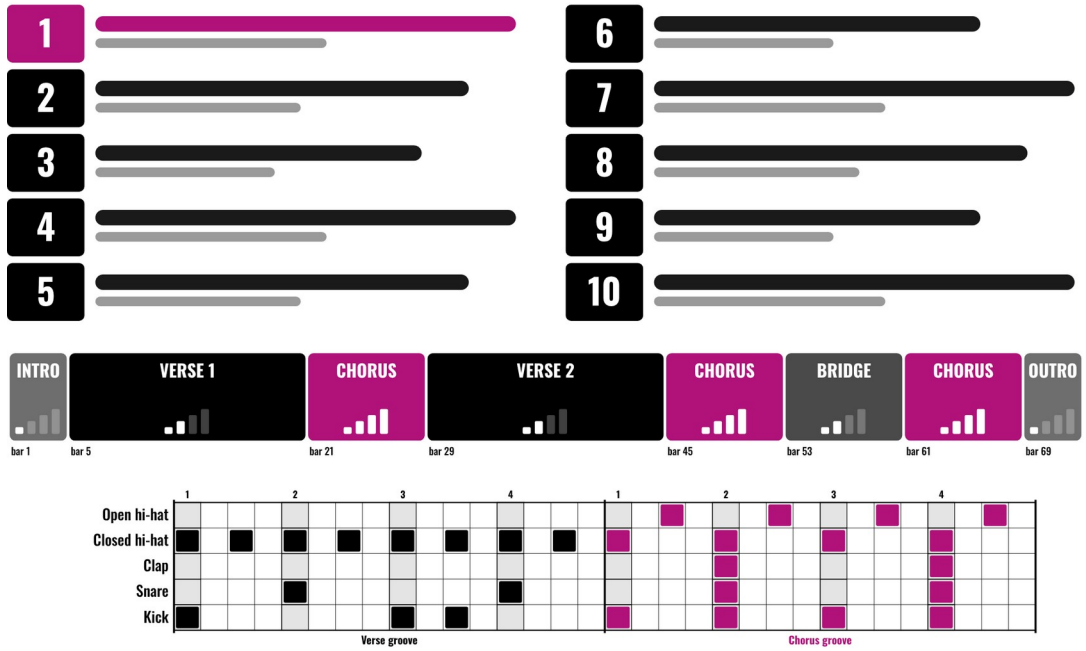
SCORED 1–5 · FINAL GRADE = AVERAGE OF YOUR SCORE AND MINE · / 25

PRESENTATION DAY

- Play your track for the class
- Your Padlet post: 3 questions about your project
- Answer at least 2 of each classmate’s 3
- Listen like a producer: what made it work?

ONE LAST THING...

- You studied a hit.
- You matched its tempo and form.
- You built the drums yourself.
- You listened like a producer.



REFLECTION · PAGE 20

Write it or talk it through: what went well, what was hard, what you would change.